PIANO BUTLER · DRAFT COLLECTION

Rhythm Activities & Games

The activity bank, free printables and thirteen games for rhythm. The Handbook and Workbook are kept as separate books.

Draft · November 2026 · 26 pages

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Each part keeps its own page numbers inside, as it will when printed on its own.

RHYTHM · STEP 1

Feel the beat

Beat or rhythm?

★☆☆

FEEL THE BEAT LEVEL 0 AT THE PIANO FREE PRINTABLE R1-01

Play any piece (or listen to one). Tap your foot on the beat and clap the rhythm of the tune. Then swap: clap the beat, tap the rhythm.

Foot beat, hands rhythm ○ ○ ○

Hands beat, foot rhythm ○ ○ ○

Slow to fast

★☆☆

FEEL THE BEAT LEVEL 0 PUZZLE FREE PRINTABLE R1-02

Number the metronome marks from the slowest (1) to the fastest (4).

♩ = 120	♩ = 60	♩ = 92	♩ = 76
☐	☐	☐	☐

Strong beats

★☆☆

FEEL THE BEAT LEVEL 0 WRITE IT R1-03

Each dot is one beat. Circle the strong beat in every bar; in 4/4, also underline the medium beat.

2/4 ● ● | ● ● |

3/4 ● ● ● | ● ● ● |

4/4 ● ● ● ● | ● ● ● ● |

Two, three or four?

★★☆

FEEL THE BEAT LEVEL 0 LISTEN R1-04

Someone plays a piece, or a march, a waltz and a song online. Count along and decide how many beats are in each bar.

MUSIC	BEATS IN A BAR
_____	2 · 3 · 4
_____	2 · 3 · 4
_____	2 · 3 · 4

Tempo ladder

★★☆

FEEL THE BEAT LEVEL 0 CHALLENGE FREE PRINTABLE R1-05

Clap the line while counting aloud. Tick a step each time it is steady, then move the metronome up.



♩ = 60	♩ = 72	♩ = 84	♩ = 96	♩ = 108
○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○

Walk the beat

★☆☆

FEEL THE BEAT LEVEL 0 AT THE PIANO R1-06

Set the metronome to ♩ = 80. Walk one step on every beat, saying the counts. Stop on beat 1 when someone says “freeze”.

2/4 (left, right)	○ ○ ○
3/4 (a step and a sway)	○ ○ ○
4/4	○ ○ ○

RHYTHM · STEP 2

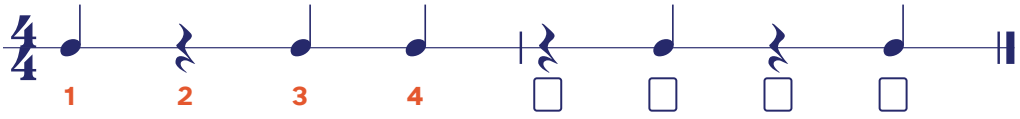
Crotchets and crotchet rests

Count it

★☆☆

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS LEVEL 0 WRITE IT R2-01

Write a count in every box. Count the rests too: they are beats of silence.

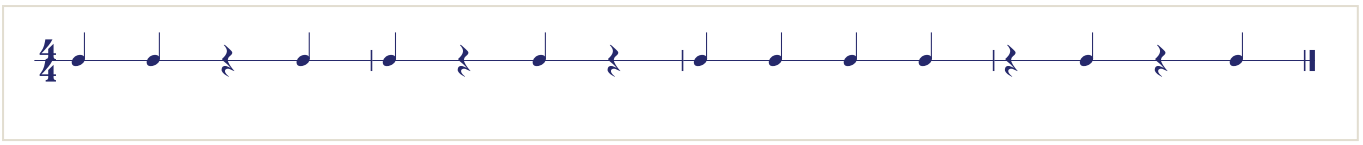


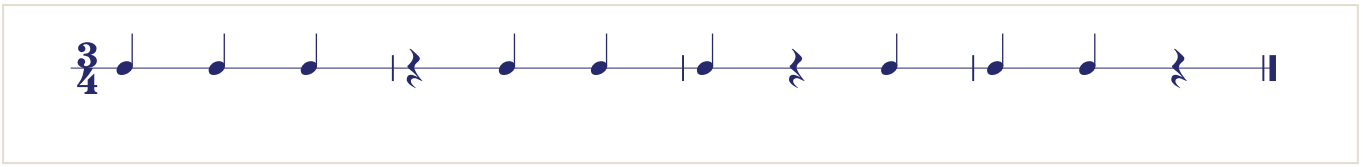
Clap and open

★☆☆

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS · LEVEL 0 · AT THE PIANO · FREE PRINTABLE · R2-02

Clap on every crotchet; open your hands wide on every rest. Count aloud.





○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Which did you hear?

★★☆

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS · LEVEL 0 · LISTEN · R2-03

Someone claps one rhythm from the row. Circle A, B or C. Then swap roles.

A 

B 

C 

Finish with rests

★★☆

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS · LEVEL 0 · WRITE IT · R2-04

Each bar is short. Complete it with crotchet rests (draw as many as you need).



rests ☐



rests ☐



rests ☐



rests ☐

Rhythm echo

★☆☆

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS · LEVEL 0 · AT THE PIANO · FREE PRINTABLE · R2-05

Someone claps one bar of crotchets and rests; you clap it straight back without a pause. Colour a square for every echo that is exactly right.

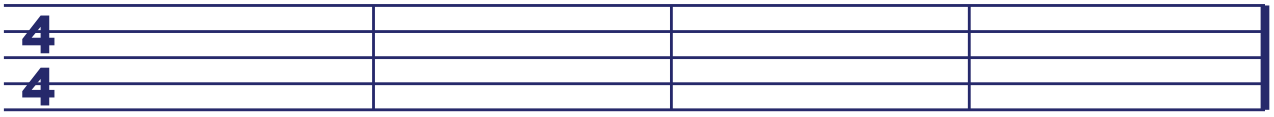
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Rest patterns

★★☆

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS LEVEL 0 MAKE YOUR OWN R2-06

Make four different bars of 4/4 using crotchets and crotchet rests. No two the same. Clap each one.



Two hands

★★★

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS LEVEL 0 CHALLENGE R2-07

Right hand plays the top line on one key, left hand the bottom line on another. Slowly, then faster.



right hand



left hand

RHYTHM · STEP 3

Minims and semibreves

Count it

★☆☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 WRITE IT R3-01

Write a count in every box: the beat you play, then the beats you hold.

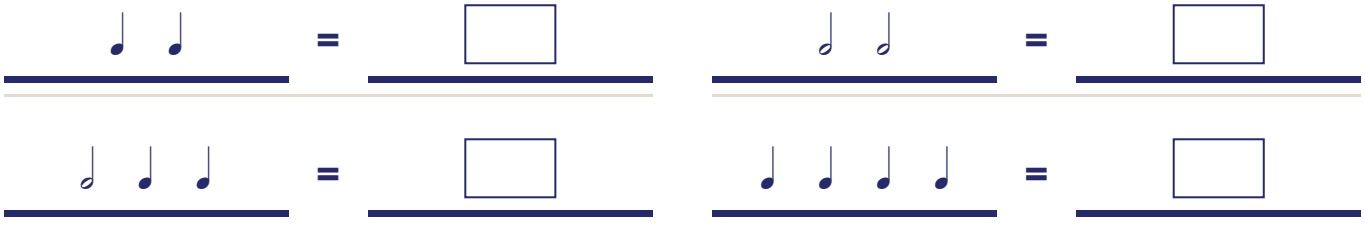


Balance the scales

★☆☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 PUZZLE FREE PRINTABLE R3-02

Write one note on the right so both sides last the same.

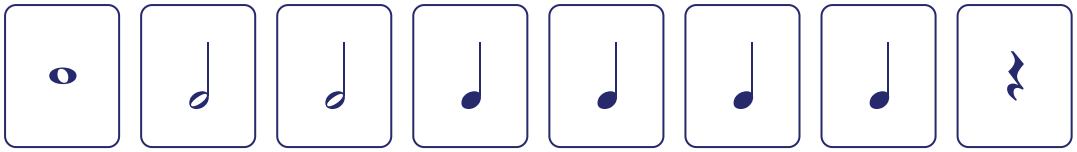


Rhythm dominoes

★★☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 PUZZLE FREE PRINTABLE R3-03

Use the cards to fill one bar of 4/4 exactly (4 beats). How many different ways can you find? Write each way by drawing the notes.



1 _____ 2 _____

3 _____ 4 _____

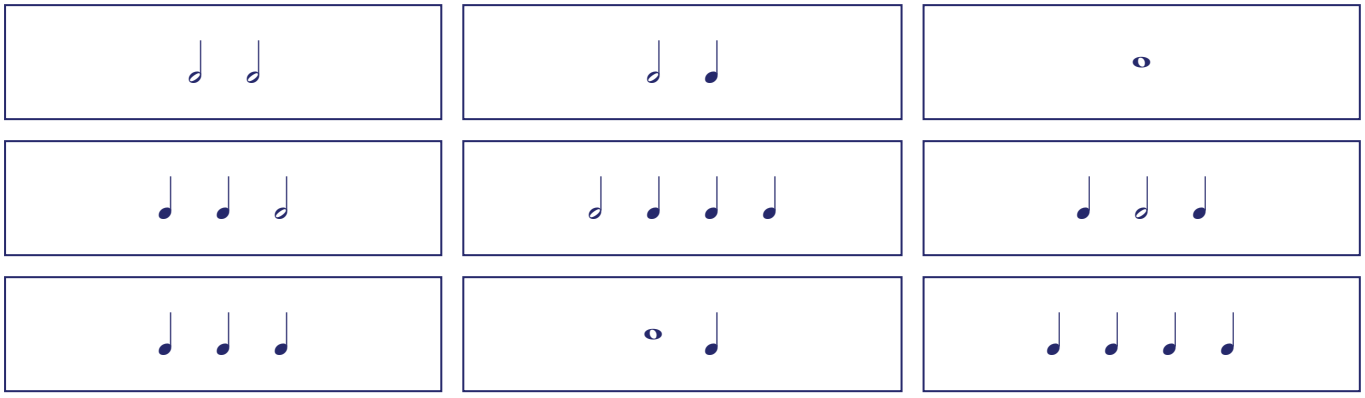
5 _____ 6 _____

Full bar hunt

★★☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 PUZZLE FREE PRINTABLE R3-04

Colour every box that holds exactly four beats.

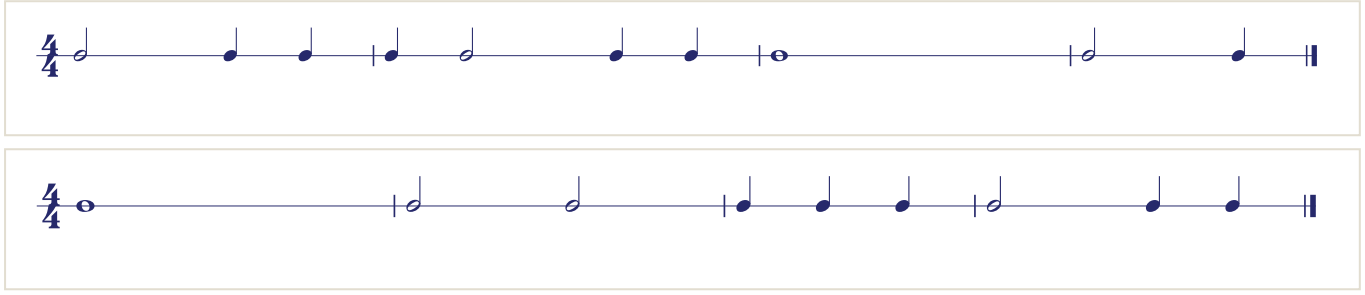


Rhythm detective

★★☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 FIND AND FIX R3-05

Each line has one bar with the wrong number of beats. Circle it and fix it.



Short or long?

★★☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 LISTEN R3-06

Someone claps one rhythm from the row. Circle A, B or C.

A 

B 

C 

Question and answer

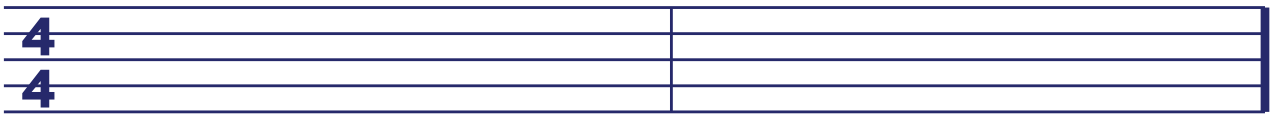
★★★

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 MAKE YOUR OWN R3-07

The first two bars ask a question. Write two bars that answer it, ending on a long note. Play it on one key.



question



In your music

★☆☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 YOUR MUSIC R3-08

Find these in a piece you are learning.

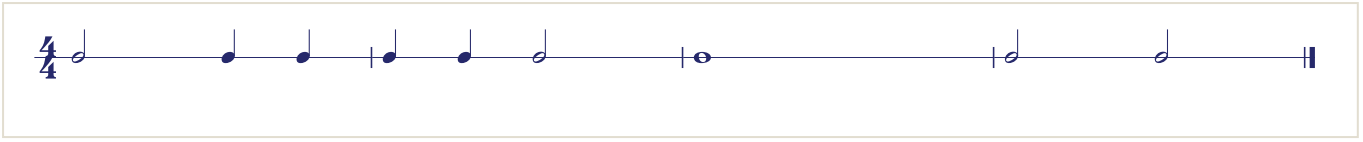
FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
a minim		
a semibreve		
a crotchet rest		
a bar of four crotchets		

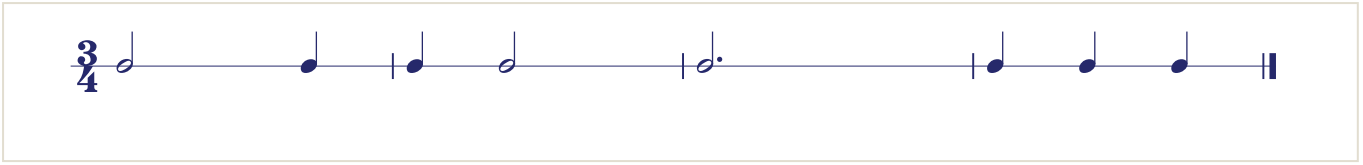
Clap and count

★☆☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 AT THE PIANO FREE PRINTABLE R3-09

Clap and count each line, holding your hands together through the long notes.





RHYTHM · STEPS 1–3

Answers

ACTIVITY	ANSWER
R1-02 Slow to fast	60, 76, 92, 120
R1-03 Strong beats	beat 1 of every bar; in 4/4 also beat 3
R2-01 Count it	1 2 3 4 · 1 2 3 4 (rests on 1 and 3)
R2-04 Finish with rests	1 · 1 · 2 · 1 crotchet rests
R3-01 Count it	1–2 3 4 · 1–2–3–4 · 1 2–3 4
R3-02 Balance the scales	minim · semibreve · semibreve · semibreve
R3-03 Rhythm dominoes	e.g. semibreve · two minims · minim + two crotchets · four crotchets · minim + crotchet + crotchet rest …
R3-04 Full bar hunt	boxes 1, 3, 4, 6, 9
R3-05 Rhythm detective	line 1: bar 2 (5 beats) · line 2: bar 3 (3 beats)

FREE RHYTHM SHEET

Feel the beat

1 Beat or rhythm?

★☆☆

Play any piece (or listen to one). Tap your foot on the beat and clap the rhythm of the tune. Then swap: clap the beat, tap the rhythm.

Foot beat, hands rhythm ○ ○ ○

Hands beat, foot rhythm ○ ○ ○

2 Slow to fast

★☆☆

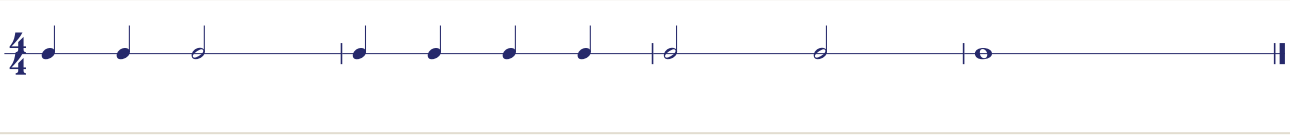
Number the metronome marks from the slowest (1) to the fastest (4).

♩ = 120	♩ = 60	♩ = 92	♩ = 76
☐	☐	☐	☐

3 Tempo ladder

★★☆

Clap the line while counting aloud. Tick a step each time it is steady, then move the metronome up.



♩ = 60	♩ = 72	♩ = 84	♩ = 96	♩ = 108
○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○

Answers 2: 60, 76, 92, 120

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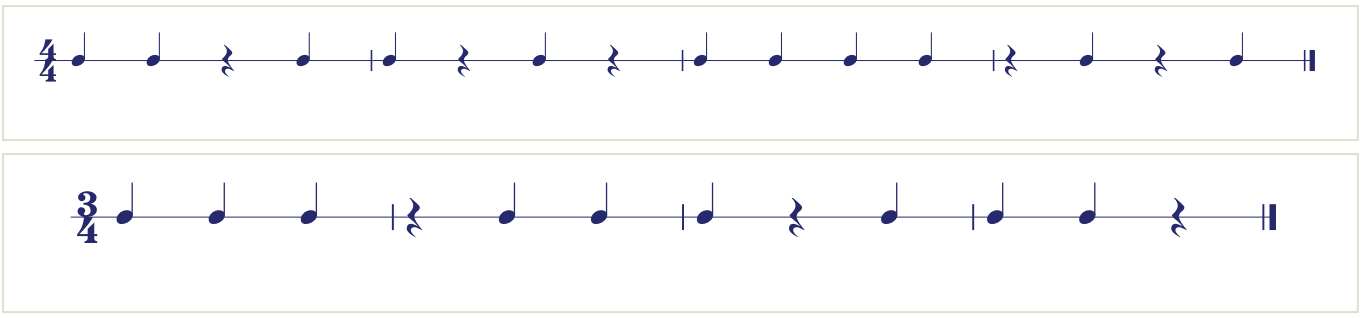
FREE RHYTHM SHEET

Crotchets and rests

1 Clap and open

★☆☆

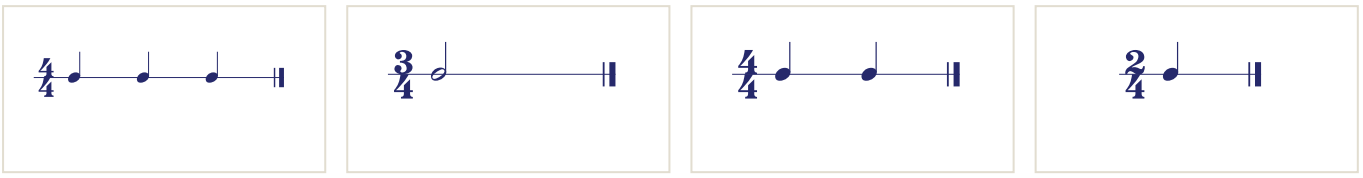
Clap on every crotchet; open your hands wide on every rest. Count aloud.



2 Finish with rests

★★☆

Each bar is short. Complete it with crotchet rests (draw as many as you need).



rests ☐ rests ☐ rests ☐ rests ☐

3 Rhythm echo

★☆☆

Someone claps one bar of crotchets and rests; you clap it straight back without a pause. Colour a square for every echo that is exactly right.

Answers 2: 1 · 1 · 2 · 1 crotchet rests

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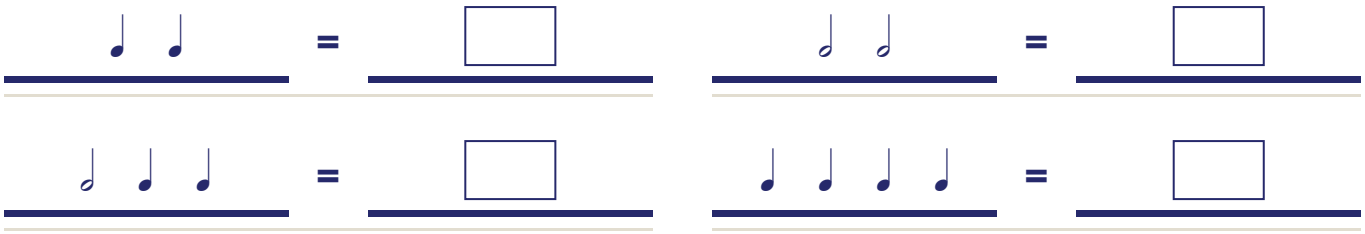
FREE RHYTHM SHEET

Long notes

1 Balance the scales

★☆☆

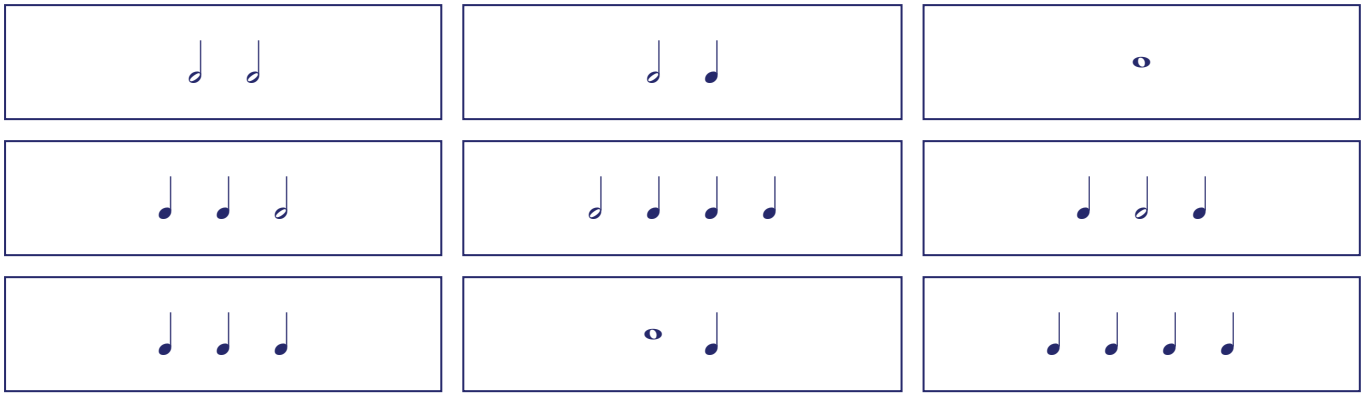
Write one note on the right so both sides last the same.



2 Full bar hunt
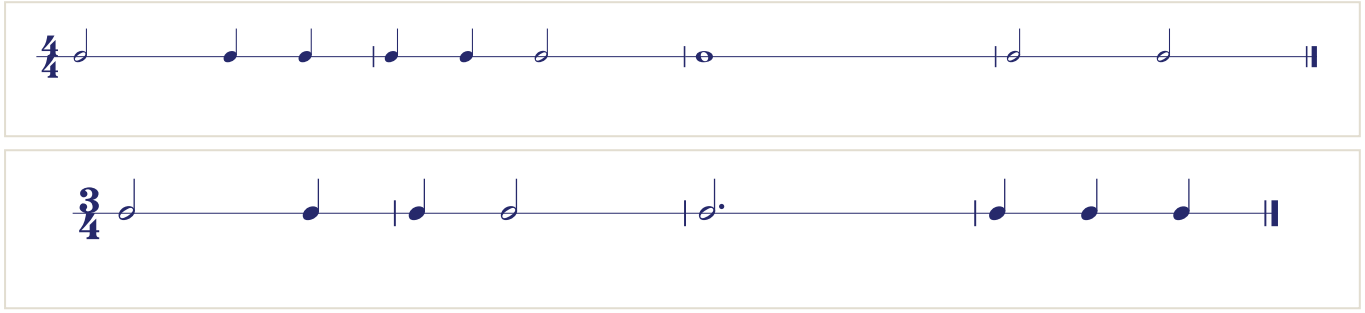
★★☆

Colour every box that holds exactly four beats.



3 Clap and count

★☆☆

Clap and count each line, holding your hands together through the long notes.



Answers 1: minim · semibreve · semibreve · semibreve · 2: boxes 1, 3, 4, 6, 9

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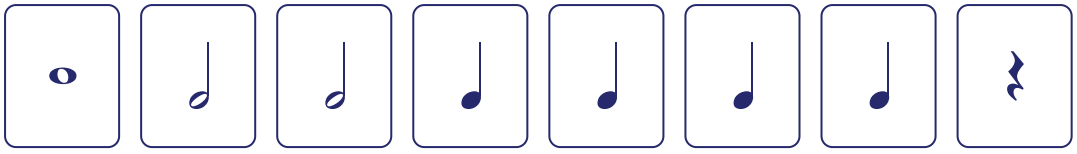
FREE RHYTHM SHEET

Rhythm puzzles

1 Rhythm dominoes

★★☆

Use the cards to fill one bar of 4/4 exactly (4 beats). How many different ways can you find? Write each way by drawing the notes.



1 _____ 2 _____

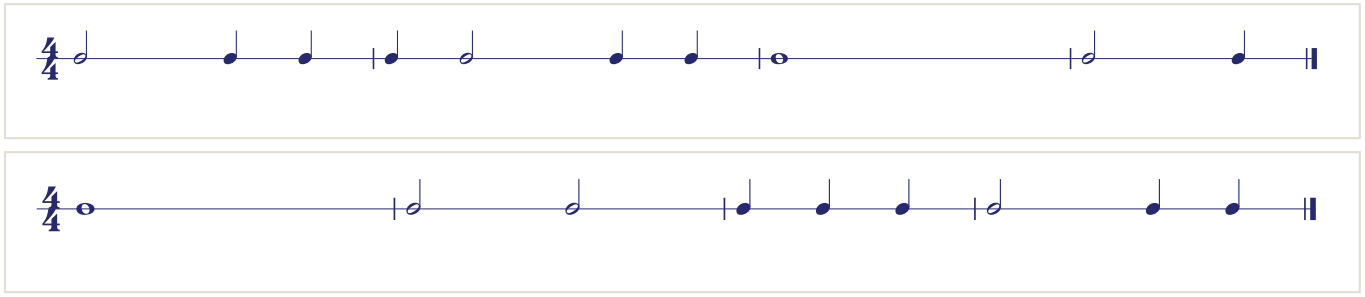
3 _____ 4 _____

5 _____ 6 _____

2 Rhythm detective

★★☆

Each line has one bar with the wrong number of beats. Circle it and fix it.



Answers 1: e.g. semibreve · two minims · minim + two crotchets · four crotchets · minim + crotchet + crotchet rest · … · 2: line 1: bar 2 (5 beats) · line 2: bar 3 (3 beats)

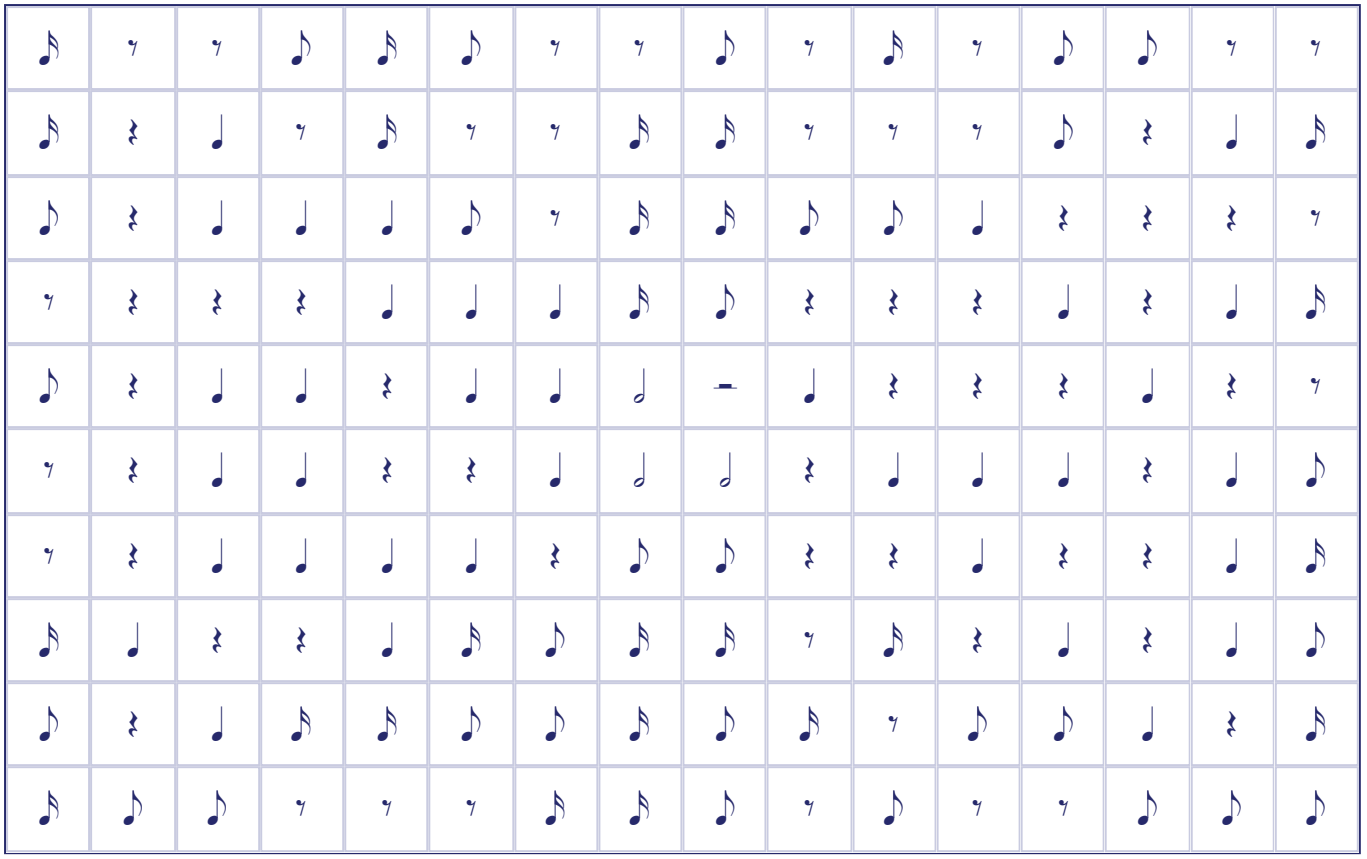
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RHYTHM GAME

Colour by beats

Every square holds a note or a rest. Colour it by how many beats it lasts (crotchet = 1 beat). Something will appear.

1 beat: navy **2 beats: coral** **less than 1 beat: leave white**



Then

Clap the top row from left to right, counting aloud: every note and rest in its place. Then the bottom row, backwards.

Answer, upside down: ǝıʇ ʍoɹ sʼɹǝʇʇnB ouıɐ ʇɥǝ

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RHYTHM GAME

The secret code

Each bar of 4/4 stands for a letter. Clap each bar of the message, find it in the code book, and write its letter underneath.

Code book

P		I	
A		N	
O		T	
E		S	
L		Y	

Message 1



Message 2



Your turn

Write your own name in rhythm code, then give it to a friend to decode.

Answers, upside down: ʎɐlԀ · ONAIԀ

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RHYTHM GAME

Rhythm bingo

For two to twenty players. The caller cuts out the call cards and claps one at a time (each lasts two beats). Players mark the matching square. Three in a row wins: clap your line back to prove it.

PLAYER CARD A

		
	FREE	
		

PLAYER CARD B

		
	FREE	
		

PLAYER CARD C
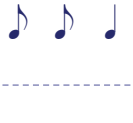
		
	FREE	
		

PLAYER CARD D

		
	FREE	
		

Caller's cards

✂ cut along the lines

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RHYTHM GAME

Race to the double bar

Two to four players, one die, a counter each. Roll and move. Clap the rhythm on your square while counting aloud: if another player agrees it was right, stay; if not, go back to where you were. First to the final bar wins.

1 	2 	3 **Rest** miss a turn	4 	5 	6
12 	11 **Repeat** back 3	10 	9 	8 	7 **Pause** roll again
13 	14 	15 **Pause** roll again	16 	17 	18 **Rest** miss a turn
24 **Final bar** you win	23 	22 	21 **Repeat** back 3	20 	19 

Start on square 1.

Harder: play the rhythm on the piano instead of clapping, at ♩ = 80.

Team game: one claps, the other counts aloud.

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RHYTHM GAME

Rhythm memory

For two to four players. Cut out the 16 cards and lay them face down. Turn over two: a rhythm and its name and beats make a pair. Clap the rhythm to keep the pair. Most pairs wins.

Cards

✂ cut along the lines

crotchet **1**			
minim **2**			
	dotted crotchet + quaver **2**	two quavers **1**	
dotted minim **3**	semibreve **4**	crotchet rest **1**	minim rest **2**

Harder: play without the names, matching rhythms that last the same number of beats.

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RHYTHM GAME

Rhythm dominoes

Cut out the dominoes. Join them in a ring: a rhythm must touch a number that matches how many beats it lasts. Clap each rhythm as you place it.

Dominoes

✂ cut along the lines

1	♩ ♩	2	𝅗𝅥.	3	𝅝
4	♩. ♪	2	♩ ♩	3	𝄽
1	𝅝	4	♩ ♩ ♩	3	♩ ♩
2	𝅗𝅥 𝅗𝅥	4	𝄽	1	♩ ♩ ♩
3	𝅗𝅥. ♩	4	♩. ♪	2	♩

Two players: share out the dominoes and take turns to add one to either end. If you cannot go, clap the last rhythm and pass.

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RHYTHM GAME

Rhythm word search

Twelve rhythm words are hidden across, down and diagonally. First name the five pictures, then find all twelve words.

C	Q	C	C	R	O	T	C	H	E	T	C	G
V	H	U	A	Y	N	N	Y	R	E	V	S	V
E	O	F	A	E	L	H	Y	H	G	F	U	G
T	O	S	Y	V	C	P	B	D	D	B	B	T
E	I	H	O	I	E	B	P	Y	S	L	E	T
M	F	C	E	H	S	R	A	U	Y	Y	A	C
P	M	I	N	I	M	I	G	R	G	T	T	A
O	C	I	P	R	H	B	B	F	L	I	N	T
V	S	E	M	I	B	R	E	V	E	E	E	C
N	E	R	M	T	T	V	E	V	B	A	S	N
P	U	L	S	E	L	B	A	Y	C	S	C	L
M	E	E	C	T	R	I	P	L	E	T	C	R
U	R	N	B	E	M	N	C	S	D	O	T	C

Name them



Also find

TIE · DOT · BAR · BEAT · PULSE · TEMPO · TRIPLET

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RHYTHM GAME

Rhythm sudoku

Each row, each column and each 2 × 2 box must hold all four rhythms once. Draw the missing ones, then clap each row: it makes two bars of 4/4.



PUZZLE 1 ★

♩ ♩			
	♩ 𝄽		
𝅗𝅥		♩ 𝄽	♪ ♪ ♩
♩ 𝄽		𝅗𝅥	♩ ♩

PUZZLE 2 ★★

𝅗𝅥	♩ ♩		
	𝅗𝅥	♪ ♪ ♩	
	♩ 𝄽		𝅗𝅥

PUZZLE 3 ★★★ (ONLY FIVE CLUES)

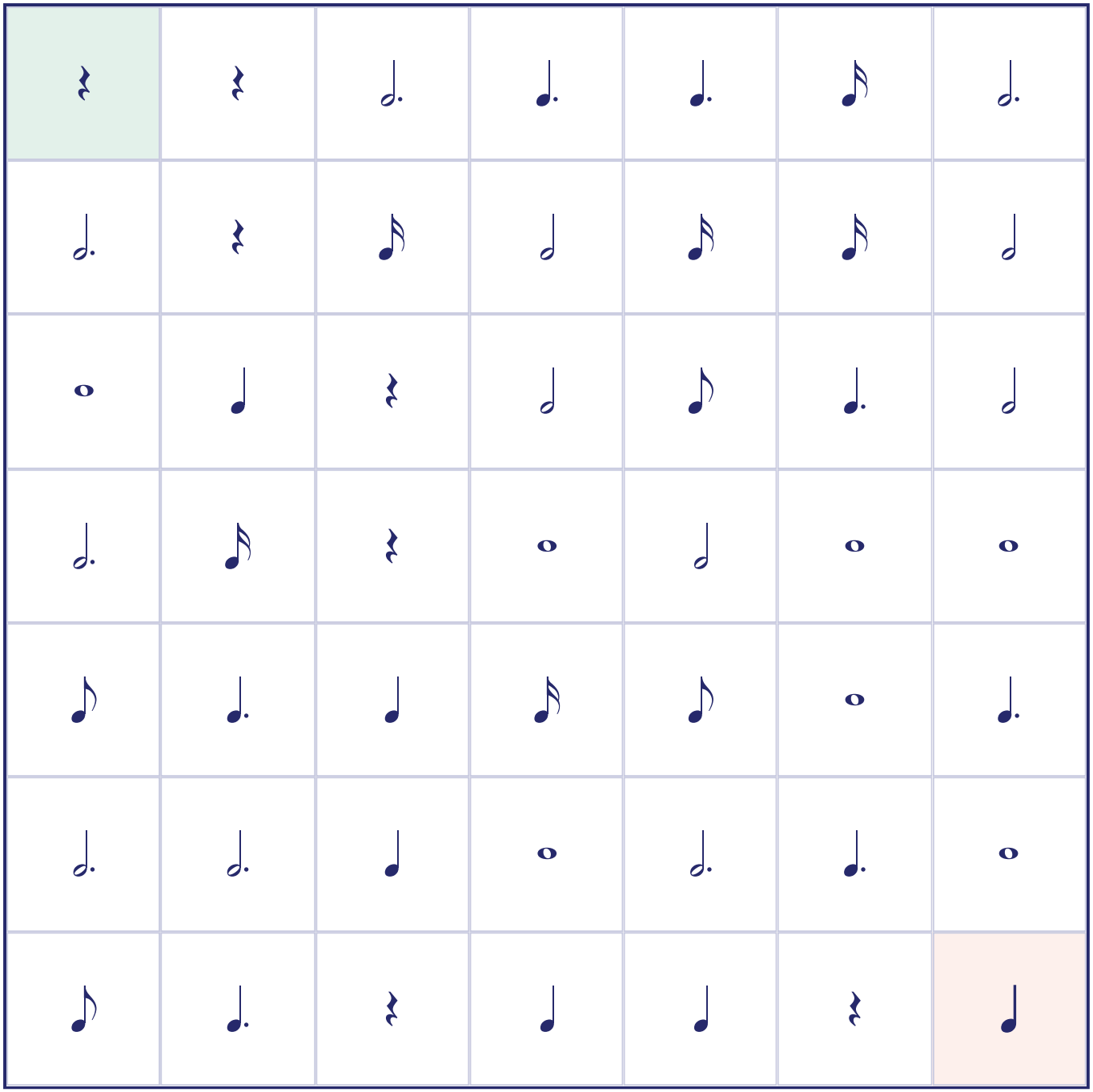
		𝅗𝅥	
	♩ ♩		♪ ♪ ♩
♪ ♪ ♩	♩ 𝄽		

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RHYTHM GAME

One-beat path

Get from START to FINISH stepping only on squares worth exactly one beat (a crotchet or a crotchet rest). Move up, down, left or right, never diagonally. Then clap your path as one long rhythm.



START: top left **FINISH: bottom right**

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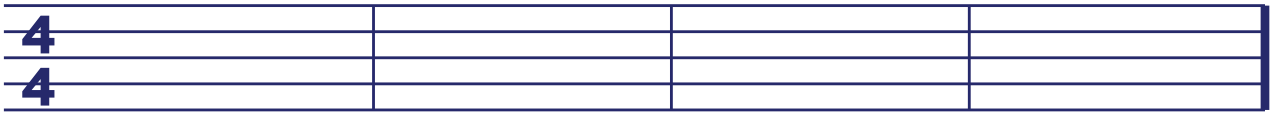
RHYTHM GAME

The dice composer

Two hundred years ago, composers sold dice games for writing music by chance. Roll a die four times: the first roll chooses bar 1, the second bar 2, and so on. Copy your bars below, clap them, then play them on one key, or on a five-finger scale.

	BAR 1	BAR 2	BAR 3	BAR 4
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				

My piece



Clapped it · Played it · Played it to someone

There are 6 × 6 × 6 × 6 = 1,296 possible pieces.

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RHYTHM GAME

The rhythm café

Every dish on the menu has a rhythm: say it and clap it. Then order a meal that fills exactly one bar of 4/4 (4 beats). Write your order and its rhythm, and clap it to the waiter.

Café Rubato · Menu

Tea	♩	*tea*
Juice	♩	*juice*
Coffee	♪ ♪	*cof-fee*
Cocoa	♪ ♪	*co-coa*
Lemonade	♪ ♪ ♩	*lem-on-ade*
Pancakes	♪ ♪ ♩	*pan-cakes*
Ice cream	♩ ♩	*ice cream*
Watermelon	𝅘𝅥𝅯 𝅘𝅥𝅯 𝅘𝅥𝅯 𝅘𝅥𝅯	*wa-ter-mel-on*
Pie	𝅗𝅥	*pie… (long)*

My orders

1 _____ _____

2 _____ _____

3 _____ _____

Make your own menu: your favourite foods, or your family's names.

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RHYTHM GAME

Rhythm escape room

You are locked in the practice room. Each lock gives one digit. Solve all four and write the code on the door to escape.

LOCK 1



How many beats in this bar?

LOCK 2



How many rests?

LOCK 3



Beats in a dotted minim?

LOCK 4

How many quavers make a semibreve?

The door

Answer, upside down: 8 ε ε 4

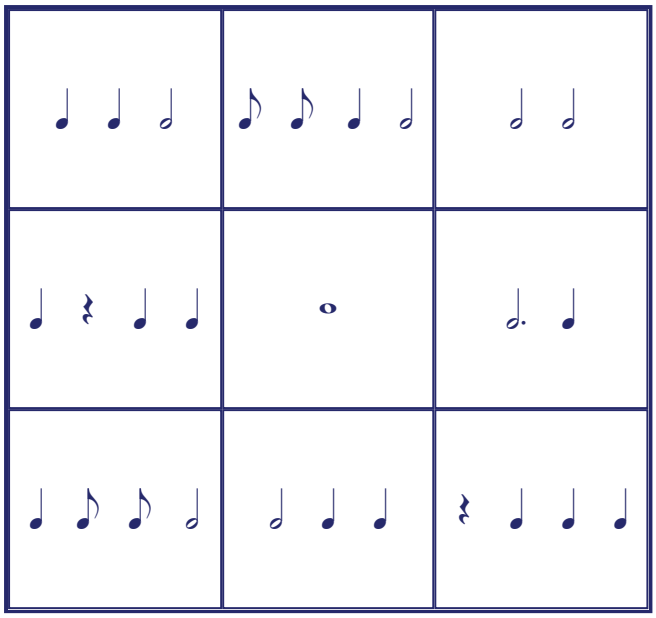
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RHYTHM GAME

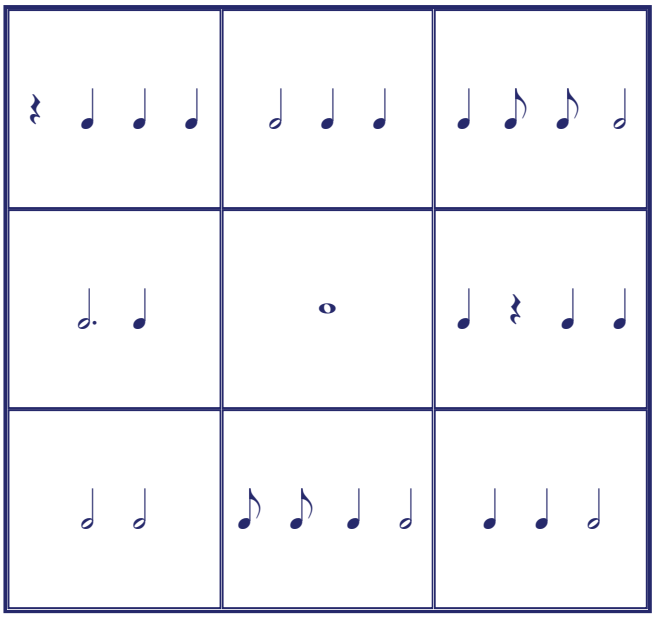
Rhythm noughts and crosses

Two players. To claim a square, clap its rhythm correctly while counting aloud; your partner judges. Claimed: draw your O or X. Three in a row wins.

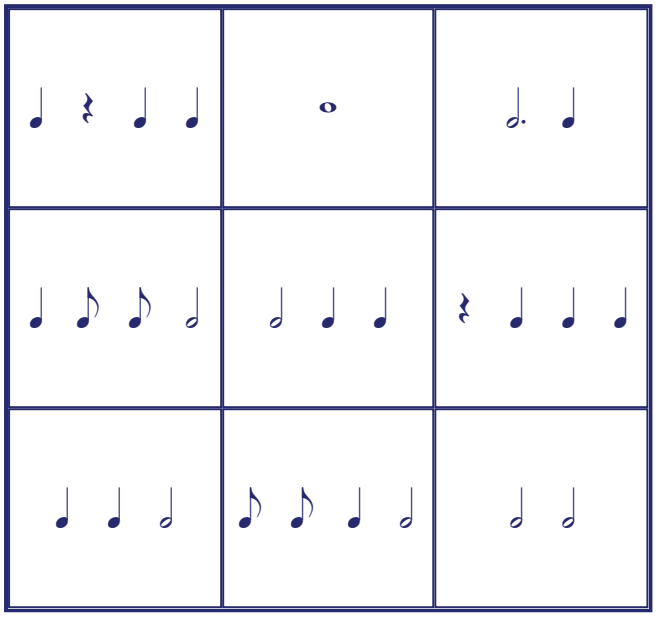
GAME 1: CLAP



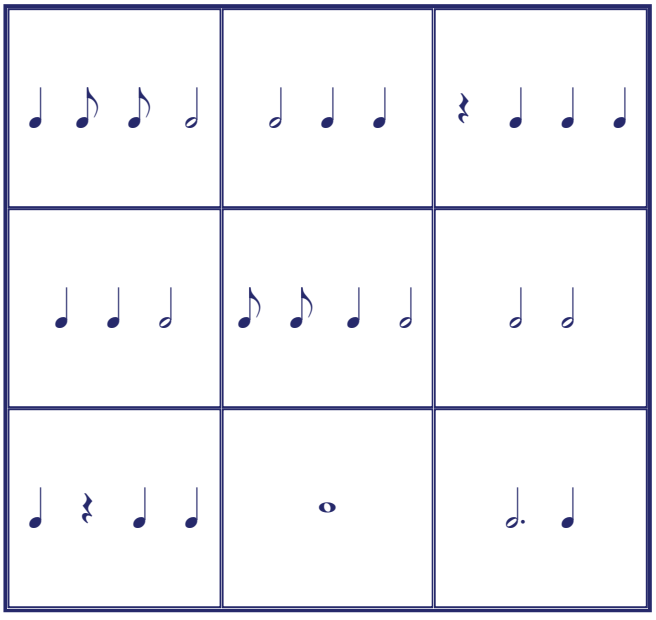
GAME 2: CLAP



GAME 3: PLAY ON ONE KEY



GAME 4: PLAY IT, EYES CLOSED



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